

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 16

Jumla Ismiyyah · The Mu'arraf bil Lam as Mubtada

1. The parts of a Jumla Ismiyyah and the three conditions

A *Jumla Ismiyyah* is made up of two fundamental parts. The *Mubtada* is the *Ism* with which a *Jumla Ismiyyah* begins, and the *Khabar* is the part of the sentence that supplies some information or report about the *Mubtada*. The *Khabar* may be an *Ism* and it may also be a *Fi'l*.

Condition	Details	How strictly it holds
Wus'at	The <i>Ism</i> made the <i>Mubtada</i> must be <i>Ma'rifah</i> , and the <i>Ism</i> made the <i>Khabar</i> must be <i>Nakirah</i>	99 percent
I'raab	Both the <i>Mubtada</i> and the <i>Khabar</i> are <i>Marfoo'</i> . Whatever noun occupies the place of <i>Mubtada</i> or <i>Khabar</i> always remains in the state of <i>raf'</i>	100 percent
'Adad and Jins	Both are <i>Wahid</i> , or both <i>Tathniyah</i> , or both <i>Jam'</i> . Likewise both are <i>Mudhakkar</i> or both <i>Mu'annath</i>	99 percent

The reason for the exceptions: Some nouns are used only as masculine or only as feminine and have no counterpart of the opposite gender. In such cases the condition of agreement in gender cannot be met, and it is here that the exceptional situations arise.

2. Several Khabars for a single Mubtada

Rule: In the Qur'an, two or more *Khabars* — that is, *Nakirah* nouns — sometimes follow one another for a single *Mubtada*, a *Ma'rifah* noun, **without any Harf ul 'Atf** between them. All these *Khabars* agree with the *Mubtada* in *I'raab*, gender and number.

Four examples from Surah al-Baqarah

Verse	Mibtada	First Khabar	Second Khabar	Ref.
وَاللَّهُ عَزِيزٌ حَكِيمٌ	اللَّهُ	عَزِيزٌ	حَكِيمٌ	228
وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ	اللَّهُ	غَفُورٌ	رَحِيمٌ	218
وَاللَّهُ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ	اللَّهُ	سَمِيعٌ	عَلِيمٌ	224
وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ حَلِيمٌ	اللَّهُ	غَفُورٌ	حَلِيمٌ	225, 235

- وَاللَّهُ عَزِيزٌ حَكِيمٌ — and Allah is Mighty, Wise.
- وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ — and Allah is Most Forgiving, Most Merciful.
- وَاللَّهُ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ — and Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing.
- وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ حَلِيمٌ — and Allah is Most Forgiving, Most Forbearing.

In every example **اللَّهُ** is *Ma'rifah* and *Marfoo'* for being the *Ism ul Jalalah*, and both *Khabars* are *Nakirah* and *Marfoo'*. No waw comes between them.

An example from Surah al-Ikhlās

قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ

(Surah al-Ikhlās: 1)

Translation: Say: He is Allah, One.

Here **اللَّهُ** is the *Mibtada* and **أَحَدٌ** is its *Khabar*.

3. The patterns of adjectives: intensity, abundance and permanence

In Arabic grammar particular patterns are used to produce in an *Ism us Sifah* the sense of intensity, abundance or permanence.

3.1 The pattern Fa'ool — for intensity and abundance

This pattern produces the sense of "very much" in the meaning.

Word	Meaning
غَفُورٌ	one who forgives a very great deal
صَبُورٌ	of a human being, one who is very patient; of Allah, the One of utmost forbearance

Word	Meaning
شَكُورٌ	of a human being, one who is very grateful; of Allah, the One who appreciates abundantly
كَنُودٌ	exceedingly ungrateful
كُفُورٌ	greatly ungrateful, or given to disbelief
غُرُورٌ	one who deceives greatly — this word is used of Shaytan

إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِرَبِّهِ لَكَنُودٌ

(Surah al-'Adiyat: 6)

Translation: Indeed man is, to his Lord, exceedingly ungrateful.

إِنَّ وَعْدَ اللَّهِ حَقٌّ فَلَا تَغُرَّنَّكُمُ الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا وَلَا يَغُرَّنَّكُم بِاللَّهِ الْغُرُورُ

(Surah Luqman: 33)

Translation: Indeed the promise of Allah is true, so let not the life of this world deceive you, nor let the great deceiver deceive you concerning Allah.

3.2 The pattern Fa'eel — for permanence and continuity

This pattern carries the sense of continuity and of being found at all times.

Word	Meaning
رَحِيمٌ	one who is always and abundantly merciful
سَمِيعٌ	one who at every moment hears all things
عَلِيمٌ	one who at every moment knows all things

The difference between the two patterns: فَعُولٌ lays its weight on **quantity**, that is, on the action being very great. Whereas فَعِيلٌ lays its weight on **continuity**, that is, on the quality being permanently and constantly present. This is why غَفُورٌ is rendered "one who forgives much" and رَحِيمٌ "one who is ever merciful".

3.3 The five well-known patterns of Mubalaghah

Both patterns above in fact belong to the family of the *Siyagh ul Mubalaghah*. The scholars of *Sarf* have set out five well-known patterns of *mubalaghah*:

Pattern	Examples	Sense
فَعَّال	غَفَّار ، فَهَّار ، تَوَّاب	the action occurring repeatedly and in abundance
مِفْعَال	مِغْطَاء ، مِقْدَام	some quality being found in great measure
فَعُول	غَفُور ، شَكُور ، صَبُور	intensity and abundance
فَعِيل	رَحِيم ، عَلِيم ، سَمِيع	permanence and continuity
فَعِل	حَدِر ، قَطِن	the quality being inherent and deep-rooted

4. The Mu'arraf bil Lam as Muftada

When اَلْ is placed at the beginning of a *Nakirah* noun in Arabic, that noun becomes particular and determined, that is, it becomes *Ma'rifah*. Such a noun is called *Mu'arraf bil Lam*, and it can serve as the *Muftada*.

Rule: If the *Muftada* is singular the *Khabar* will be singular too, and both remain *Marfoo'*.

Sentence	Translation
الرَّجُلُ صَادِقٌ	the man is truthful
البَابُ مَفْتُوحٌ	the door is open
الجَوُّ حَارٌّ	the weather is hot
الْعِلْمُ نَافِعٌ	knowledge is beneficial
اللَّبَنُ مُفِيدٌ	milk is beneficial

5. The difference of gender between Urdu and Arabic

An important principle: Some nouns are spoken as feminine in Urdu but are masculine in Arabic. The *Khabar* always comes according to the gender of the Arabic noun, not according to the gender it has in Urdu. This is the point at which an Urdu-speaking student errs most often.

Nouns that are Mudhakkar in Arabic

Sentence	Translation
الشَّاي حَارٌّ	the tea is hot
الشُّبَّاكُ مُغْلَقٌ	the window (the latticed or barred kind) is shut
الجِدَارُ قَدِيمٌ	the wall is old

Nouns that are Mu'annath in Arabic

Sentence	Translation
الْقَهْوَةُ حَارَّةٌ	the coffee is hot
النَّافِذَةُ مُغْلَقَةٌ	the window (the plain kind) is shut
السَّيَّارَةُ ثَمِينَةٌ	the car is expensive
السَّاعَةُ جَمِيلَةٌ	the watch is beautiful

Worth noting: There are two separate words for a window, and their gender differs as well. **الشُّبَّاكُ** is used of a latticed or barred window and is masculine, while **النَّافِذَةُ** is used of a plain window and is feminine.

6. When the Mubtada is of mixed gender

الْبَابُ وَالنَّافِذَةُ مَفْتُوحَانِ

(the door and the window are open)

Here a masculine and a feminine noun — and lifeless ones at that — have come together as the *Mubtada*, so the *Khabar* has come in the masculine. And since the *Mubtada* is two, the *Khabar* has been brought as a masculine *Tathniyah*, مَفْتُوحَانِ. This is the rule of *Taghleeb*.

7. The division into 'Aqil and Ghayr 'Aqil

By the reckoning of Arabic grammar, all nouns and all creation are divided into two basic categories.

Category	Definition	Examples
'Aqil	Only three kinds of creation fall in this category: human beings, jinn and angels	رَجُلٌ ، أَسْتَاذٌ ، إِبْلِيسُ ، جِبْرَائِيلُ
Ghayr 'Aqil	All things, animals and inanimate objects besides the three kinds named above	كِتَابٌ ، بَابٌ ، بَقَرَةٌ ، مَسْجِدٌ ، كُرْسِيٌّ

8. The Khabar of a Ghayr 'Aqil plural

Rule: When the *Mubtada* of a *Jumla Ismiyyah* is a plural of the *Ghayr 'Aqil* — whether a *Jam' Mukassar* or a *Jam' Salim* — two forms are permissible for its *Khabar*. **The first** is that the *Khabar* be brought as **singular feminine**, and this is the preferable and more frequently used form. **The second** is that it be brought as a *Jam' Salim Mu'annath*, and this is permissible too.

Mubtada singular	Mubtada dual	Mubtada Ghayr 'Aqil plural
الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ	الْكِتَابَانِ جَدِيدَانِ	الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدَةٌ / جَدِيدَاتٌ
السَّاعَةُ جَمِيلَةٌ	السَّاعَتَانِ جَمِيلَتَانِ	السَّاعَاتُ جَمِيلَةٌ / جَمِيلَاتٌ

Evidence from the Qur'an

The first form, the singular feminine *Khabar*, is used abundantly in the Qur'an.

وَجُوهٌ يَوْمَئِذٍ خَاشِعَةٌ

(Surah al-Ghashiyah: 2)

Translation: On that day some faces will be humbled.

وَجُوهٌ is a *Jam' Mukassar* and *Ghayr 'Aqil*, which is why its *Khabar* خَاشِعَةٌ has come as singular feminine.

قُلُوبٌ يَوْمَئِذٍ وَاجِفَةٌ

(Surah an-Nazi'at: 8)

Translation: On that day some hearts will be throbbing.

قُلُوبٌ is likewise a *Jam' Mukassar* and *Ghayr 'Aqil*, and its *Khabar* وَاجِفَةٌ is singular feminine.

وَالنُّجُومُ مُسَخَّرَاتٌ بِأَمْرِهِ

(Surah al-A'raf: 54)

Translation: And the stars are subjected by His command.

Here the second form has been adopted. **النُّجُومُ** is a *Ghayr 'Aqil* plural and its *Khabar* **مُسَخَّرَاتٌ** has come as a *Jam' Salim Mu'annath*. This shows that both forms are present in the Qur'an.

9. Siyghah Muntaha al-Jumoo' and the word al-Karasiyy

In Arabic grammar a particular pattern of the *Jam' Mukassar* is called the *Siyghah Muntaha al-Jumoo'*, and it is one of the major causes of a noun being *Ghayr Munsarif*.

How it is recognised: The mark of this pattern is that the first and second letters of the noun carry a fathah, followed by an additional alif, and after the alif there are either **two letters**, as in **مَسَاجِدُ**, or **three letters** provided the middle one is silent, as in **مَفَاتِيحُ**.

Analysis of the word al-Karasiyy

The *Jam' Mukassar* of **كُرَاسِيٍّ** is **كُرَاسِيٍّ**. In its outward form the word appears to have only two letters after the alif, but the reality of a doubled letter is that it is in fact two letters: one silent and one carrying a vowel.

Form	The word	Letters after the alif
As it appears	كُرَاسِيٍّ	س ، ي
With the shaddah opened	كُرَاسِيِي	س ، ي ، ي

Once the shaddah is opened out, three letters follow the alif — seen, silent yaa' and voweled yaa' — and the middle one of them is silent. The word therefore stands on the pattern **مَفَاعِيْلُ** as a *Muntaha al-Jumoo'*, and for that reason it is *Ghayr Munsarif*.

But here al- is present: A *Ghayr Munsarif* noun takes neither *Tanween* nor a kasrah. But as was seen in Lecture 11, once *alif lam* enters it, it does accept a kasrah in the state of *jarr*. So **الْكُرَاسِيُّ** with al- will be read just like any ordinary *mu'rab* noun.

Summary

1. A Jumla Ismiyyah has two parts: the Muftada and the Khabar. The Khabar may be an Ism and it may also be a Fi'l.
2. There are three conditions: the Muftada Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah (99 percent), both Marfoo' (100 percent), and agreement in 'adad and jins (99 percent).
3. Two or more Khabars for a single Muftada may follow one another without any Harf ul 'Atf.
4. All such Khabars agree with the Muftada in I'raab, gender and number.
5. Surah al-Baqarah has four examples of this: **عَفُورٌ حَلِيمٌ** and **عَزِيزٌ حَكِيمٌ**, **عَفُورٌ رَّحِيمٌ**, **سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ**.
6. The pattern **فَعُولٌ** comes for intensity and abundance, that is, for the action being very great.
7. **عَفُورٌ** and **عَرُورٌ** all stand on this pattern.
8. The pattern **فَعِيلٌ** comes for permanence and continuity, as in **عَلِيمٌ** and **رَّحِيمٌ**.
9. **فَعُولٌ** lays its weight on quantity, while **فَعِيلٌ** lays its weight on continuity.
10. The five well-known patterns of Mubalaghah are: **فَعِيلٌ**, **فَعُولٌ**, **مُفَعَّلٌ**, **فَعَالٌ** and **فُعِلَ**.
11. Placing al- on a Nakirah noun makes it Mu'arraaf bil Lam and fit to serve as the Muftada.
12. Some nouns are spoken as feminine in Urdu but are masculine in Arabic, and the Khabar always follows the gender of the Arabic noun.
13. **السَّاعَةُ** and **الْقَهْوَةُ**, **النَّافِذَةُ**, **السَّيَّارَةُ** are feminine, while **الشَّيْبَانِ** and **الشَّيْبَانِ** are masculine in Arabic.
14. There are two words for a window: **الشَّيْبَانِ** (latticed, masculine) and **النَّافِذَةُ** (plain, feminine).
15. If a masculine and a feminine together form the Muftada, the Khabar comes in the masculine, as in **النَّافِذَةُ مَفْتُوحَانِ**.
16. Only three kinds of creation are 'Aqil: human beings, jinn and angels. All else is Ghayr 'Aqil.
17. When the Muftada is a Ghayr 'Aqil plural, bringing the Khabar as singular feminine is preferable and more frequent, while a Jam' Salim Mu'annath is permissible too.
18. **وَجُودٌ خَاشِعَةٌ** and **قُلُوبٌ وَاجِفَةٌ** are examples of the first form, and **النُّجُومُ مُسَخَّرَاتٌ** of the second.
19. Muntaha al-Jumoo' is recognised by a fathah on the first and second letters, then an additional alif, and after the alif two letters, or three of which the middle is silent.
20. In **كَرَاسِيٍّ**, opening the shaddah gives three letters after the alif with the middle one silent, so it stands on the pattern **مَفَاعِيلٌ** as a Muntaha al-Jumoo' and is Ghayr Munsarif.

Exercise

1. Write all three conditions of a Jumla Ismiyyah and state how strictly each holds.
2. Write the rule concerning several Khabars for one Muftada and give two examples from Surah al-Baqarah.
3. Analyse the Muftada and both Khabars separately in **وَاللَّهُ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ**.
4. Write the sense of the pattern **فَعُولٌ** and give four of its words with their meanings.
5. Write the sense of the pattern **فَعِيلٌ** and give three examples.

6. What is the difference in sense between فَعُول and فَعِيل?
7. Write all five patterns of Mubalaghah with examples.
8. Form five sentences with the Mu'arraḥ bil Lam and translate each.
9. Write the three nouns that are feminine in Urdu but masculine in Arabic, and four that are feminine in Arabic.
10. What is the difference between النَّافِذَةُ and الشَّبَّابُ?
11. Why is the Khabar masculine and dual in أَلْبَابُ وَالنَّافِذَةُ مَفْتُوحَانِ?
12. Define 'Aqil and Ghayr 'Aqil and give three examples of each.
13. When the Muḥtadā is a Ghayr 'Aqil plural, which two forms of Khabar are permissible, and which is preferable?
14. Write both permissible Khabars for السَّاعَاتُ and الْكُتُبُ.
15. Write how Muntahā al-Jumoo' is recognised and give two examples.
16. Write the word كَرَّاسِيٌّ with its shaddah opened out and explain how it becomes a Muntahā al-Jumoo'.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ